



STATUS REPORT

Botswana: status report

Edition of 2026-08-26 · 98 systems and instruments tracked

Compiled 2026-08-26 by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository, from [outputs/reports/BWA/Ledger.csv](#) (98 systems and instruments, 11 of them **Not held**). Each section opens with its ledger; specific events are covered in the monthly updates. Figures are dated because most are time-varying.

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Status values. *Implemented* — in operation or in force. *Piloting* — running with a limited user group or in a controlled environment. *In development* — build or drafting under way, not yet operating. *Planned* — announced or provided for, no build or draft on record. *Enacted* — an instrument passed into law; pair with a qualifying clause for its in-force date. *Under review* — a law or policy currently being reconsidered. *Discontinued* — closed or superseded. *Not held* — the base carries no reliable statement of status; these are the gaps to fill and are listed again at the end.

Summary of position

The data-protection regulator became an enforcing body in this window. It [suspended a government payroll portal by enforcement notice on 17 July 2026](#), the first published enforcement against a government body, having a year earlier run on [three contract officers with no premises, address or website](#). It still has no budget organisation or line of its own.

The identity layer is the weakest part of the stack. The [national public key infrastructure has P423m secured, control transferred to the intelligence directorate, no working system, no timeline and no accountable owner](#), which leaves Botswana with no certificate-backed identity verification and no recognised electronic-signature layer; identity-card production is [degraded by too few staff and ageing equipment with frequent breakdowns](#).

The budget is the clearest part. Digital development lines were cut for FY2026/27 against FY2025/26 outturns already low — the [communications ministry ICT project from P369,079,545 to P251,000,000, on a P142,712,599 outturn at 38.7%](#) — and no Auditor General figure exists for any year. Eleven of the rows below are *Not held*.

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Digital Services Authority	PLANNED ↗	Announced in the FY2026/27 ministry plan; no establishing instrument found
ICT Roadmap 2030	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Set out at a high-level policy dialogue, 2026-03-09
National E-Waste Management Strategy	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched with a regulator and environment-department memorandum, 2026-07-13

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Cybersecurity Act 2025	PLANNED, AWAITING COMMENCEMENT NOTICE ↗	Assented 2025-11-05, gazetted 2025-11-11, commencement on notice
Digital Services Act	IMPLEMENTED ↗	In force 2025-11-21 with a 24-month compliance window to November 2027
Electronic Payment Services (Amendment) Regulations 2026	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Published and in effect 2026-04-02; central-bank implementation release 2026-07-17
National Cybersecurity Authority	PLANNED ↗	Provided for by the 2025 Act; no appropriation line found
Remote Service VAT Act	IMPLEMENTED ↗	In effect 2026-06-01; 14% VAT on non-resident digital and remote services
Virtual Asset Act 2022 and provider licensing	IMPLEMENTED, OVERSIGHT GAPS FLAGGED ↗	A regional follow-up assessment finds provider-oversight shortcomings

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Data Protection Act No. 18 of 2024	IMPLEMENTED ↗	In force 2025-01-14, repealing the never-commenced 2018 Act
Determination and enforcement notice against the public service management directorate	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Public notice dated 2026-07-17; compliance evidence due within one month
Information and Data Protection Commission	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Determination and enforcement notice issued 2026-07-17

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Botswana-Namibia ICT memorandum of understanding	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Signed at Kasane 2026-08-07
Botswana-South Africa innovation memorandum	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Signed 2026-08-19
SADC One Network Area roaming	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Extended to five further SADC states, announced 2026-03-13
SADC regional internet exchange host bid	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Shortlisted to the final two with a Zimbabwean company

Standards

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
ITU Radio Regulations Board candidature	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Candidature promoted at a regional preparatory meeting, 27-29 May 2026
National IPv6 transition plan	NOT HELD	—

The [Digital Services Act](#) came into force on 21 November 2025 with a compliance clock to November 2027; the [Cybersecurity Act 2025](#), assented and gazetted in November, is not in force, a stated April 2026 commencement having passed with no notice. The authority it creates has a board, a chief executive, licensing power over cybersecurity providers and power to approve software before market placement — and no organisation or vote in the FY2026/27 estimates. A Digital Services Authority announced in the FY2026/27 ministry plan has no establishing instrument and was contested as duplicative in August 2025.

The [Data Protection Act](#) has been in force unchanged since 14 January 2025; enforcement moved — action against non-bank financial institutions in February 2026 and a government directorate in July.

The [Remote Service VAT Act](#) took effect on 1 June 2026, charging 14% on non-resident digital and remote services against a stated collection target of about P450m a year. Roaming cuts of between 10% and 98.6% now cover six [SADC states](#). The ministry announced an [ICT memorandum with Namibia for signature on 6 August 2026](#), adding digital transformation, emerging technologies and cybersecurity to roaming and cable-transit cooperation; no term or funding was published. No IPv6 transition plan and no open-data portal or policy are held.

Finance

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Basic education ministry computerisation	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Appropriated in the FY2026/27 estimates
Communications ministry ICT project	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Appropriated in the FY2026/27 estimates
Communications ministry research and development project	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Appropriated in the FY2026/27 estimates
Higher education ministry computerisation	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Appropriated in the FY2026/27 estimates
Revenue service modernisation line	PLANNED ↗	P4.13bn sought from Parliament in the twelfth development plan
Shared Digital Services department recurrent vote	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Appropriated in the FY2026/27 estimates
Audited outturn for digital budget lines	NOT HELD	—

MoUs and other agreements

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Orange Botswana and special economic zones memorandum	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Signed at the operator's head office, reported 2026-03-17

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Botswana Tech Fund	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched 2026-04-21; first close reported 2026-04-27
Scalar Botswana Innovation Program	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched in Gaborone 2026-03-10
Universal fund annual allocation and school target	NOT HELD	—

The appropriations are the strongest evidence in this report and they read as retrenchment. For FY2026/27 the [communications ministry ICT project](#) falls to P251,000,000 from P369,079,545, a third consecutive cut from P736.6m in FY2024/25; [basic education computerisation](#) falls to P253,000,000 from P270,000,000, on a FY2025/26 outturn of P0; and the [research and development project](#) falls to P213,700,000 from P477,403,718, on a 9.0% outturn. The [largest single recurrent digital line](#) is essentially flat at P587,310,850, and the only line fully spent in FY2025/26 was [higher education computerisation](#), which rises to P16,000,000. No audited outturn exists for any of them.

One procurement runs against that retrenchment: a [P654.4m learning-technology contract awarded by direct procurement on 25 June 2026](#), its financial evaluation received, adjudicated and approved the same day, out of a vote that spent nothing the previous year.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
BoFiNet internet gateway upgrade	IMPLEMENTED ↗	P100m spent; the Gaborone exchange point relocated
BoFiNet Local Access Projects 2025/26	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Completion reported 2026-08-16; first integrated report presented at the 2026-08-13 AGM
BTC rural satellite connectivity programme	IMPLEMENTED ↗	61 villages connected, 105 further areas in progress
MTC Namibia and BoFiNet cross-border fibre memorandum	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Gobabis-Buitepos fibre completed and interconnected with BoFiNet at Charles Hill
Powertel-Paratus fibre corridor	IMPLEMENTED, PHASE 1 ONLY ↗	Plumtree-Bulawayo section live and carrying traffic
Village Connectivity Project	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Stated ongoing at an industry congress, May 2026

Data Storage

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Data-localisation amendment to the Data Protection Act	PLANNED ↗	Announced by the minister at the Digital Delta launch
Digital Delta Data Centre	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched 2025-11-25 after Tier III certification in October 2025
Government migration to Digital Delta	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Initial phase targeted for mid-2026
Kala Data Centre	IMPLEMENTED ↗	First full quarter of continuous operation, quarter ended 2026-06-30
Palapye solar data-centre campus	PLANNED ↗	Memorandum signed; the campus to sit inside a planned energy hub and industrial park

Energy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Kala hybrid gas and solar generation	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Solar introduced to cover periods of lower gas availability
Lesedi 5MW solar development	PLANNED ↗	Options assessed during the quarter, scalability under review
Lesedi gas gathering network extension	PLANNED ↗	Stated subject to funding
Palapye 250MW solar and storage	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Stated under development at the memorandum signature

Cybersecurity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Cybercrime and Computer Related Crimes Act 2018	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Its repeal takes effect only on the 2025 Act's commencement
Liquid Secure360	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Service portfolio launched in Botswana
National Cyber Drill	IMPLEMENTED ↗	A four-day drill held, opened by the regulator's chief executive
National Cybersecurity Strategy	NOT HELD	—

Botswana's network position is stated by ministers and unverified elsewhere. The country has [about 16,000 km of fibre laid](#), on a ministerial statement with no published register behind it, and the only national capacity figure in the base is [just over 100Gbps of international traffic in February 2025](#), eighteen months old. Internet penetration is [2.09m users and 81.4% at end-2025](#) on a reference study, against a regulator figure of about 73% three weeks earlier; the two are unreconciled.

Rural reach is described without measurement: a satellite programme has [61 villages connected with 105 areas in process](#), and the [Village Connectivity Project is running with no site count, target, budget or completion date](#).

Data-centre capacity is the one area with hard specification, and it is thin. The state's [Digital Delta facility is Tier III certified and carrier-neutral](#); the commercial [Kala centre is fully commissioned at proof-of-concept revenue, designed for up to 1MW](#), its growth gated on an upstream gas-gathering extension rather than on demand. A [Palapye campus with 250MW of solar and 100-400MW of storage](#) is a memorandum with no cost or timeline, and nothing on file since October 2025.

Security is legislated and unmanned: the [2018 cybercrime Act remains operative, its repeal enacted but not commenced](#), and no cybersecurity strategy document, date or version is on file.

DPI

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
SADC Agricultural Information Management System	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Four-day national readiness workshop in Gaborone
SADC cross-border DPI and federated eKYC framework	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Framework unveiled August 2025 by the regional central bank committee

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Electronic Identification System	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Rescoped from a public-private partnership into a broader digital identity ecosystem
Mandatory SIM registration	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Public notice, mandatory for all users
National Public Key Infrastructure	IN DEVELOPMENT, STALLED ↗	Public accounts committee told it is funded, begun, incomplete and non-operational
National Registration (Amendment) Act 2025	IMPLEMENTED ↗	In force by 2026-03-02; a passport or driving licence valid while an identity card is replaced
Omang card production and replacement	IMPLEMENTED, PRODUCTION DEGRADED ↗	Parliamentary answer: too few production staff and ageing equipment with frequent breakdowns

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Biometric grant payment cards	IMPLEMENTED ↗	More than 75,000 beneficiaries and 1,200 shops, on a platform accredited by three central banks
Citizen Wallet	PLANNED ↗	Presented to a rural development council, 2025-09-17
Instant cross-border payment corridor into Botswana	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Corridor went live 2026-03-02
Mukuru Companion Card	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched 2026-08-18
National payment switch	PLANNED ↗	Named inside a P486m ICT allocation sought under the twelfth development plan
Taxi cashless payment and financing partnership	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Unveiled in Gaborone 2026-08-09
UnionPay e-commerce acceptance	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Extended to nine African markets 2026-08-19

Registries

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Elections Management System	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Developed and under extensive testing; deployment planned for the 2029 general election
Electronic voter registration	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Electoral-reform package committed to in Parliament, 2026-08-19
Mandatory SMME registration and national database	PLANNED ↗	Nationwide consultations March to May 2026; the agency lobbying for mandatory registration

Sectoral management information systems

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Animal Disease Surveillance Dashboard	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched in the week of 2026-07-13, integrating the traceability system and district veterinary networks
Government Accounting and Budgeting System	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Committee of supply told the software upgrade completed December 2024 and the system is fully operational
Labour Market Information System	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Permanent secretary told a parliamentary committee only facilitation and training remain

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
1Gov-1Citizen platform	IMPLEMENTED ↗	FY2026/27 ministry plan records e-services increased from 33 to 52
E-Payslip portal	DISCONTINUED, SUSPENDED PENDING COMPLIANCE ↗	Directorate statement of 2026-07-22 following the regulator's enforcement notice
Mandatory electronic invoicing	PLANNED, PROVIDED FOR BY THE VALUE ADDED TAX ACT 2025 ↗	Provided for by the Value Added Tax Act 2025, in force 2026-07-01
National e-Procurement System	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Restated at a procurement conference as due at the beginning of 2027

Identity is where the base records the most damage. The public key infrastructure is **funded, begun, incomplete and non-operational**, the public accounts committee being told P423m is secured and control has passed to the intelligence directorate, with no working system and no accountable owner. The electronic identification system was **rescoped from a public-private partnership to integrate digital identity, a national wallet and e-government services, with a biometric identity card itemised at P31,700,000 in FY2026/27**. Card production is **running with delays since the start of 2026, no backlog figure and no restoration date**, while the amendment Act making a passport or driving licence valid during replacement is **in force with service providers refusing even the replacement receipt**.

Payments are legislated ahead of infrastructure. The **Electronic Payment Services (Amendment) Regulations 2026 are in operation, extending scope to money or value transfer services, reaching beneficial owners and 10% shareholders on fit-and-proper, and making unlicensed operation punishable by P1,000,000 and five years**. Against that regime, the **national payment switch is funded in plan only, with no build, procurement, operator or date**, and the **Citizen Wallet has had no build, pilot, budget line or date since September 2025**. One rail is live: an **instant cross-border corridor inbound from South Africa and Zimbabwe, with no volume figure held**.

Service delivery is counted in services rather than in use. The government platform records [e-services increased from 33 to 52](#), with no usage figure at either end, and the [payroll portal is offline with no reopening date](#). The deeds registry is [substantially manual on a workload of 9,000 to 30,000 transactions a year since the 2017-18 land Acts](#), with no digitisation programme or budget line, in a country where about 70% of land is tribal land. Nothing is held on district or council digital systems.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Local-government digital systems	NOT HELD	—

Technology

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Judicial capability on AI and digital evidence	PLANNED ↗	The Chief Justice stated the Judiciary had resolved to train judges in AI and emerging technologies
National AI policy or strategy	NOT HELD	—

ICT Industry

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
BoFiNet, the state wholesale network operator	IMPLEMENTED ↗	First integrated report, for the year ended 31 March 2025, presented at the annual general meeting 2026-08-13

Botswana holds no national AI policy, strategy or regulatory instrument at any date. The only state-side commitment in the base is the [Chief Justice's statement that the Judiciary had resolved to train judges in AI](#), with no programme, budget or date attached. Adoption is measured only from outside, at [0 to 0.40 chatbot visits per user per month on a 0 to 2.6 scale](#).

The sector's largest listed operator is contracting: [profit before tax fell 45% to P146.2m on revenue down 1.6% to P1.47bn for the year ended 31 March 2026](#), on company-reported figures. Research activity is flat: [45 projects carried forward, P9.5m spent in FY2025/26, five completed and none added](#).

External technology relationships are narrow. Botswana [acceded to the Artemis Accords on 25 June 2026 as the 68th signatory](#); a [vendor ICT academy operates across five tertiary institutions](#) with no student numbers held; and the only Gulf item is a [heads of agreement behind the Kala data centre](#) whose counterparty is not named in the operator's most recent quarterly account. Nothing is held on Indian cooperation.

Capacity

Literacy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Regulator school ICT and cyber-awareness training	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Sessions run at four schools in the week of 2026-01-22

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
National digital literacy measure	NOT HELD	—

Training and skills

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
ITU and CRASA geographic-information training	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Training commenced in Botswana with the regulator and the regional association
STEAM e-learning, coding and robotics programme	IN DEVELOPMENT, CONTRACT AWARDED ↗	Contract awarded by direct procurement 2026-06-25

Research institutions

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
National Research Agenda	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Cabinet approved July 2025; FY2025/26 spend reported to the committee of supply
University of Botswana virtual-reality programme	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched 2026-04-16 with a partner innovation hub

Inclusion

Access to services

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Mascom device-financing facility	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched 2025-05-23 as Botswana's first mobile device financing facility
Official internet penetration figure	NOT HELD	—

Digital divides

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
BTC Community Wi-Fi, Old Naledi	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched June 2025
Universal Access and Service Fund school digital centres	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Two handovers in the North West District, 22 and 23 July 2026

Universal service delivers per site and publishes no programme total. Two school digital centres were handed over in July at P1.45m and P1.5m per site, thirty machines each, from a fund financed by a 1% levy on mobile providers whose annual allocation and school target are not held. Community access is a single site: [one Wi-Fi installation at tariffs of P2 to P10 with a free 45-minute daily window](#), with no second recorded. No national digital-literacy measure and no official internet penetration figure are held.

Data

National statistics

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Africa Broadband Maps training	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Subregional geographic-information and data-management training commenced in Botswana
Second Statistics Development Strategy (2026-2030)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched 2026-08-12

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Statistician General	IMPLEMENTED ↗	A substantive appointment made October 2025, succeeding an acting holder

Open data

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
National open-data portal or policy	NOT HELD	—

Use of satellite data

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
BOTSAT-1	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched 2025-03-15 with an in-country ground station

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Artemis Accords accession	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Signed 2026-06-25 at NASA headquarters as the 68th signatory

China activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Chinese AI cooperation offer	PLANNED ↗	Offer made publicly by the ambassador, August 2026
Huawei ICT Academy in Botswana	IMPLEMENTED ↗	A 2025-2026 competition run across five named universities

EU activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
EU Cooperation Facility for digital transformation	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Committed 2022; activity period 2022-2030
EU-Botswana digital cooperation instrument since 2022	NOT HELD	—

Gulf/UAE activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Kala Data heads of agreement	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Heads of agreement negotiated March 2025; site and technical planning progressed by 2025-09-26

India activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
India-Botswana technology or digital cooperation	NOT HELD	—

Gaps to fill

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
National Cybersecurity Strategy	the strategy document itself, or a gazette notice or ministerial statement giving its date of adoption and version	not yet probed
National IPv6 transition plan	a regulator or ministry IPv6 transition plan with a target date, or a published IPv6 adoption percentage for Botswana	not yet probed
National open-data portal or policy	a named national open-data portal, a Cabinet-approved open-data policy, or a statistics-office dataset register with a publication date	not yet probed
EU-Botswana digital cooperation instrument since 2022	a named Global Gateway or development package for Botswana with a value and a signature date	not yet probed
Local-government digital systems	a local-government ministry committee-of-supply speech naming council systems, or a named council-level rates, licensing or land-allocation platform with a dated statement	not yet probed
National AI policy or strategy	a gazetted national AI policy, or the development plan's AI policy project producing a published document	not yet probed
India-Botswana technology or digital cooperation	any India-Botswana memorandum, line of credit, training record or Indian vendor contract naming Botswana	not yet probed
Official internet penetration figure	the regulator's annual report, or a statistics-office household ICT access survey	not yet probed
National digital literacy measure	a dated statistics-office or regulator household ICT survey reporting a digital-literacy or digital-skills rate	not yet probed
Universal fund annual allocation and school target	the regulator's annual report, or the universal fund's own accounts	not yet probed
Audited outturn for digital budget lines	the Auditor General's report on the accounts of the Government of Botswana for FY2024/25 or FY2025/26	not yet probed

Eleven rows carry no reliable statement, and the pattern is that Botswana's instruments are named in speeches and absent from documents. Four are missing instruments: no cybersecurity strategy, named as the coming authority's implementing mandate; no AI policy or strategy at any date; no IPv6 transition plan; and no open-data portal or policy, the only open-data item in the base being a hackathon.

Three are missing measures of the state's own delivery: no official internet penetration figure, no digital-literacy rate, and no universal-fund annual allocation or school target. One is a whole layer of government: nothing on district or council digital systems.

The remaining three bear directly on the finance section above: no audited outturn for any digital budget line in any year, no named European Union instrument behind the assistance the minister described, and no India cooperation of any kind. Each row is in [gaps.csv](#) with what would settle it; none has yet been probed on a date.

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EDITION	2026-08-26
CURRENT EDITION	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/BWA/BWA-status.html
THIS FILE	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/BWA/BWA-status-2026-08-26.pdf
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